







# Testing Spring Boot Applications Demystified

## A Hero's Journey Through the Spring Boot Testing Labyrinth

javaBin Bergen 26.02.2026

Philip Riecks - [PragmaTech GmbH](#) - [@rieckpil](#)

# Participate During the Talk

Go to [menti.com](https://menti.com) and use the code **1661 6205** to **anonymously** submit answers for the quizzes and add your questions during the talk.



center

Start with the first two questions:

- Despite having LLMs and Code Agents, do you still write your tests by hand?
- Do You Enjoy Writing Automated Tests?

At the end of the Menti, you can add your questions for the Q&A session.





# Act 1: The Grand Entrance

Testing Spring Boot applications can feel like entering a labyrinth blindfolded:

- Copying test configuration from AI/StackOverflow hoping it works
- The paradox of choice: `@SpringBootTest` , `@WebMvcTest` , `@DataJpaTest` , `@MockBean` , etc.
- Fear of refactoring because tests break for the wrong reasons
- Tests written to satisfy coverage metrics, not increase productivity, confidence or catch bugs

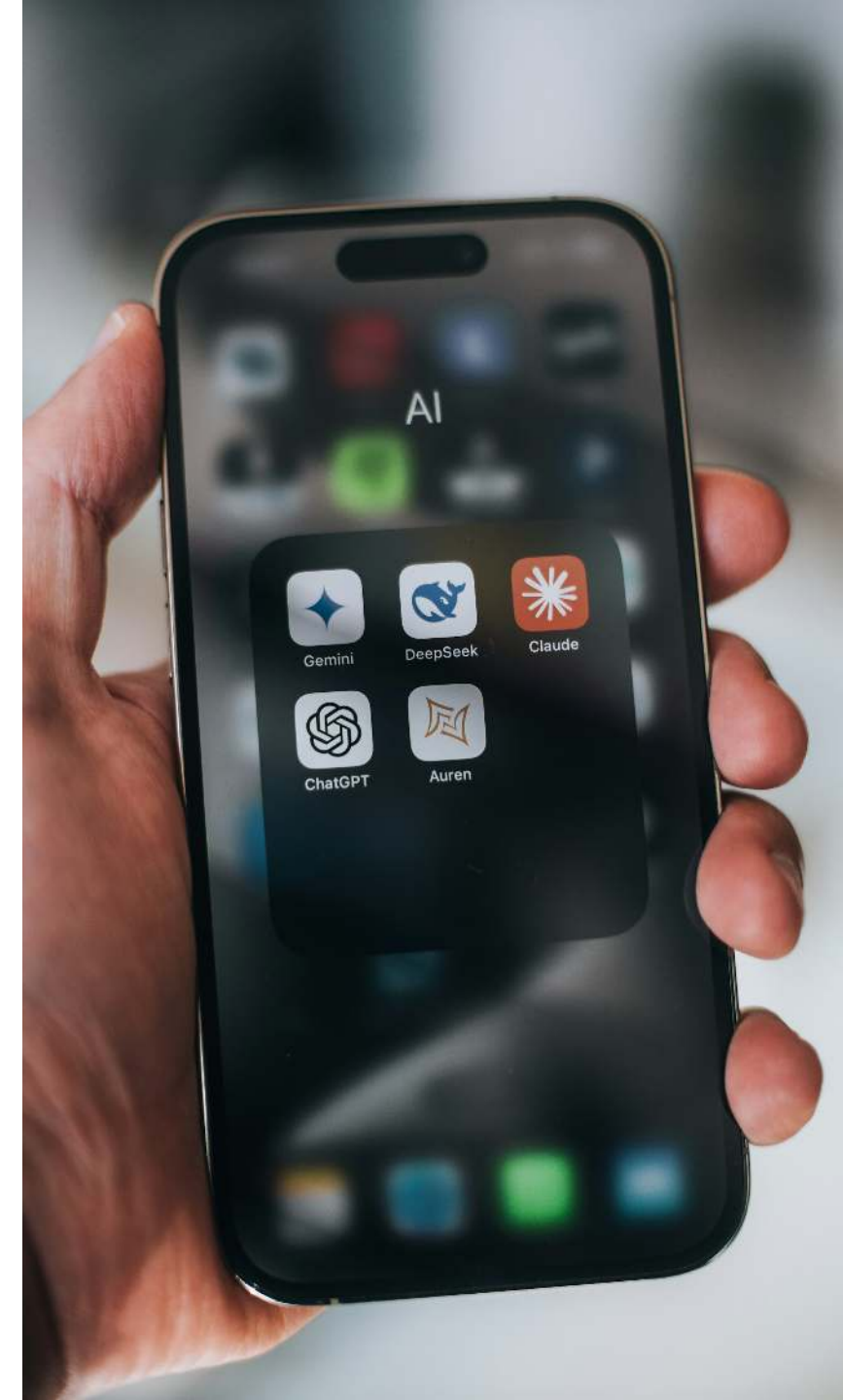
# Why Test Software?



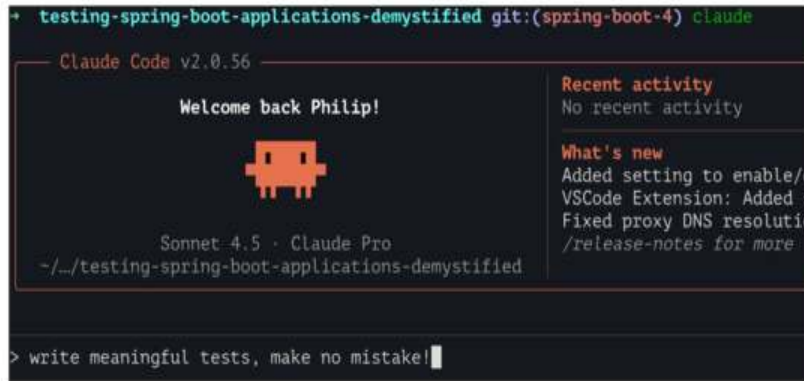


## Automated Testing in the AI Era

- AI generates the code; you own the consequences.
- Co-pilots don't carry pagers. You do.
- The faster the code is generated, the faster you need to prove it's correct.
- AI is the accelerator; your test suite is the brakes. You can't drive fast without both.
- Mass-produced code without (the correct) mass-produced tests is just technical debt at scale.



# Spring Boot Testing - The Bad & Ugly



```
@Test
// TODO: Fix test
@Disabled("Flaky test, failing randomly on CI")
void contextLoads(@Autowired WebTestClient webTestClient) {
```

```
Caused by: org.springframework.beans.factory.UnsatisfiedDependencyException:
  Error creating bean with name 'publicController' defined in file [/home/riekpil/development/c
  Unsatisfied dependency expressed through constructor parameter 0; nested exception is org.spr
  No qualifying bean of type 'de.riekpil.learning.UserService' available:
  expected at least 1 bean which qualifies as autowire candidate. Dependency annotations: {}
  ... 68 more
Caused by: org.springframework.beans.factory.NoSuchBeanDefinitionException:
  No qualifying bean of type 'de.riekpil.learning.UserService' available:
  expected at least 1 bean which qualifies as autowire candidate. Dependency annotations: {}
  ... 87 more
```



```
➔ testing-spring-boot-applications-demystified git:(spring-boot-4) ./mvnw -DskipTests package
```

# Spring Boot Testing - The Good

```
$ ./mvnw verify

[INFO] -----
[INFO] T E S T S
[INFO] -----
[INFO] Running com.example.UserServiceTest
[INFO] Tests run: 15, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0, Time elapsed: 2.
[INFO] Running com.example.PaymentControllerTest
[INFO] Tests run: 8, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0, Time elapsed: 1.4
[INFO] Running com.example.OrderProcessingTest
[INFO] Tests run: 12, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0, Time elapsed: 1.
[INFO] Running com.example.DatabaseIntegrationTest
[INFO] Tests run: 6, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0, Time elapsed: 2.2

[INFO] Results:
[INFO] Tests run: 247, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0
[INFO]
[INFO] BUILD SUCCESS
[INFO]
[INFO] Total time: 04:15 min
[INFO] Finished at: 2025-01-15T10:46:35+01:00
```

Short feedback cycles

Continuous Deployment

Refactoring  
without regression

(shorter coffee breaks)

Tests as documentation

Tests suite as a safety net

Fast deployments

Understand unknown code faster





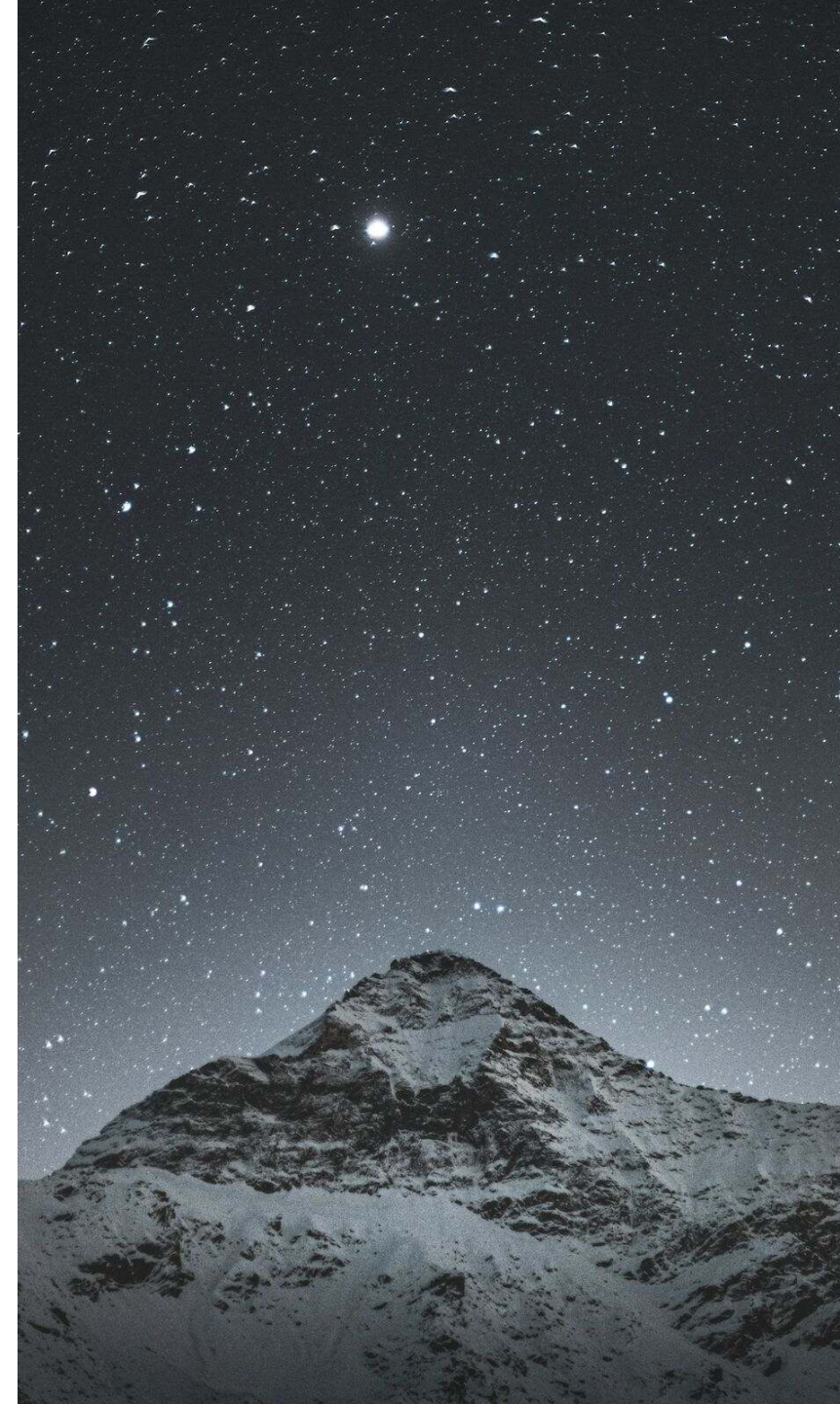
## My Overall Northstar for Automated Testing

Imagine seeing this pull request on a Friday afternoon:



How confident are you to merge this major Spring Boot upgrade and deploy it to production once the pipeline turns green?

Good tests don't just catch bugs - they give you **fast feedback** and **confident deployments**.





# The Hero's Journey aka. Our Agenda





## Goals For This Talk

- **Provide a clear mental map** for choosing between unit, slice, and integration tests so developers stop guessing which tool to use
- **Equip attendees with practical techniques** to speed up test suites and validate test quality
- **Build confidence to refactor fearlessly** by creating tests that catch real bugs, not just achieve coverage metrics



## About Philip

- Self-employed developer from Herzogenaurach, Germany (Bavaria) 📄🍺
- Blogging & content creation with a focus on testing Java and specifically Spring Boot applications 📄🌱
- Founder of PragmaTech GmbH - Enabling Developers to Frequently Deliver Software with More Confidence 📄🚤
- Enjoys writing tests (sometimes even more than production code) 📄🧪





# Quest 1

## The Unit Testing Guardian

The Swift Gatekeeper - Blocks Those Who Overcomplicate



# Our Foundation: Spring Boot Starter Test

- The "Testing Swiss Army Knife"

```
1 <dependency>
2   <groupId>org.springframework.boot</groupId>
3   <artifactId>spring-boot-starter-test</artifactId>
4   <scope>test</scope>
5 </dependency>
```

- Batteries-included for testing by transitively including popular testing libraries
- Out-of-the-box dependency management to ensure compatibility





```
1 ./mvnw dependency:tree
2 [INFO] ...
3 [INFO] +- org.springframework.boot:spring-boot-starter-test:jar:4.0.2:test
4 [INFO] | +- org.springframework.boot:spring-boot-test:jar:4.0.2:test
5 [INFO] | +- org.springframework.boot:spring-boot-test-autoconfigure:jar:4.0.2:test
6 [INFO] | +- com.jayway.jsonpath:json-path:jar:2.10.0:test
7 [INFO] | | \- org.slf4j:slf4j-api:jar:2.0.17:compile
8 [INFO] | +- jakarta.xml.bind:jakarta.xml.bind-api:jar:4.0.4:test
9 [INFO] | | \- jakarta.activation:jakarta.activation-api:jar:2.1.4:test
10 [INFO] | +- net.minidev:json-smart:jar:2.6.0:test
11 [INFO] | | \- net.minidev:accessors-smart:jar:2.6.0:test
12 [INFO] | | \- org.ow2.asm:asm:jar:9.7.1:test
13 [INFO] | +- org.assertj:assertj-core:jar:3.27.6:test
14 [INFO] | | \- net.bytebuddy:byte-buddy:jar:1.17.8:test
15 [INFO] | +- org.awaitility:awaitility:jar:4.3.0:test
16 [INFO] | +- org.hamcrest:hamcrest:jar:3.0:test
17 [INFO] | +- org.junit.jupiter:junit-jupiter:jar:6.0.2:test
18 [INFO] | | +- org.junit.jupiter:junit-jupiter-api:jar:6.0.2:test
19 [INFO] | | | +- org.opentest4j:opentest4j:jar:1.3.0:test
20 [INFO] | | | +- org.junit.platform:junit-platform-commons:jar:6.0.2:test
21 [INFO] | | | \- org.apiguardian:apiguardian-api:jar:1.1.2:test
22 [INFO] | | +- org.junit.jupiter:junit-jupiter-params:jar:6.0.2:test
23 [INFO] | | \- org.junit.jupiter:junit-jupiter-engine:jar:6.0.2:test
24 [INFO] | | \- org.junit.platform:junit-platform-engine:jar:6.0.2:test
25 [INFO] | +- org.mockito:mockito-core:jar:5.5.0:test
26 [INFO] | | +- net.bytebuddy:byte-buddy-agent:jar:1.17.8:test
27 [INFO] | | \- org.objenesis:objenesis:jar:3.3:test
28 [INFO] | +- org.mockito:mockito-junit-jupiter:jar:5.5.0:test
29 [INFO] | +- org.skyscreamer:jsonassert:jar:1.5.3:test
30 [INFO] | | \- com.vaadin.external.google:android-json:jar:0.0.20131108.vaadin1:test
31 [INFO] | +- org.springframework:spring-core:jar:7.0.3:compile
32 [INFO] | | +- commons-logging:commons-logging:jar:1.3.5:compile
33 [INFO] | | \- org.jspecify:jspecify:jar:1.0.0:compile
34 [INFO] | +- org.springframework:spring-test:jar:7.0.3:test
35 [INFO] | \- org.xmlunit:xmlunit-core:jar:2.10.4:test
```



# What's Inside the Testing Swiss Army Knife?

- **JUnit** (currently 5, later 6): Java's de-facto standard testing framework and foundation.
- **Mockito**: Creating mock objects to simulate dependencies and verify interactions.
- **AssertJ**: Provides fluent, chainable, and readable assertions.
- **Hamcrest**: Offers flexible matchers for creating custom assertions.
- **JSONAssert**: Compares JSON strings with flexible matching options.
- **JsonPath**: Extracts and queries data from JSON similar to XPath.
- **XMLUnit**: Compares and validates XML documents.
- **Awaitility**: Handles asynchronous testing with fluent conditions.





# Unit Testing Spring Boot Applications 101

- **Core Concept:** Test individual components (classes, methods) in complete isolation from their dependencies.
- **Confidence Gained:** Provides logarithmic verifications, ensuring that the smallest parts of your code work as expected under various conditions.
- **Best Practices:** Focus on a single unit of work.
- **Pitfalls:** Requires a well-thought-out class design. Poor design can lead to testing overly complex "god classes," making tests difficult to write and maintain.
- **Tools:** JUnit (or Spock, TestNG, etc.), Mockito and assertion libraries like AssertJ or Hamcrest.



# Unit Testing has Limits

Consider this sample REST controller, what could we verify with a unit test?

```
1 @RestController
2 @RequestMapping("/api/customers")
3 public class CustomerController {
4
5     private final CustomerService customerService;
6
7     public CustomerController(CustomerService customerService) {
8         this.customerService = customerService;
9     }
10
11     @PostMapping
12     public ResponseEntity<Void> createNewCustomer(@Validated CustomerCreationRequest payload, UriComponentsBuilder uriBuilder) {
13
14         String customerId = customerService.createNewCustomer(payload.firstName());
15
16         UriComponents uriComponents = uriBuilder
17             .path("/api/customers/{id}")
18             .buildAndExpand(customerId);
19
20         return ResponseEntity.created(uriComponents.toUri()).build();
21     }
22 }
```





```
1 @ExtendWith(MockitoExtension.class)
2 class CustomerControllerUnitTests {
3
4     @Mock
5     private CustomerService customerService;
6
7     @InjectMocks
8     private CustomerController customerController;
9
10    @Test
11    void shouldCreateCustomerWhenPayloadRequestIsValid() {
12        when(customerService.createNewCustomer(anyString()))
13            .thenReturn("42");
14
15        ResponseEntity<Void> result = customerController.createNewCustomer(
16            new CustomerCreationRequest("Java", "Duke", "duke@spring.io"),
17            UriComponentsBuilder.newInstance()
18        );
19
20        assertThat(result.getStatusCode().value())
21            .isEqualTo(201);
22        assertThat(result.getHeaders().getLocation().toString())
23            .isEqualTo("/api/customers/42");
24    }
25 }
```



## Things We Can't Cover With a Unit Test

- **Request Mapping:** Does HTTP GET `/api/customers/{id}` actually resolve to our desired method?
- **Validation:** Will incomplete request bodys result in a 400 bad request or return an accidental 201?
- **Serialization:** Are we JSON objects serialized and deserialized correctly?
- **Headers:** Are we setting `Content-Type` or custom headers correctly?
- **Security:** Are we Spring Security configuration and other authorization checks enforced?



## Quest 2

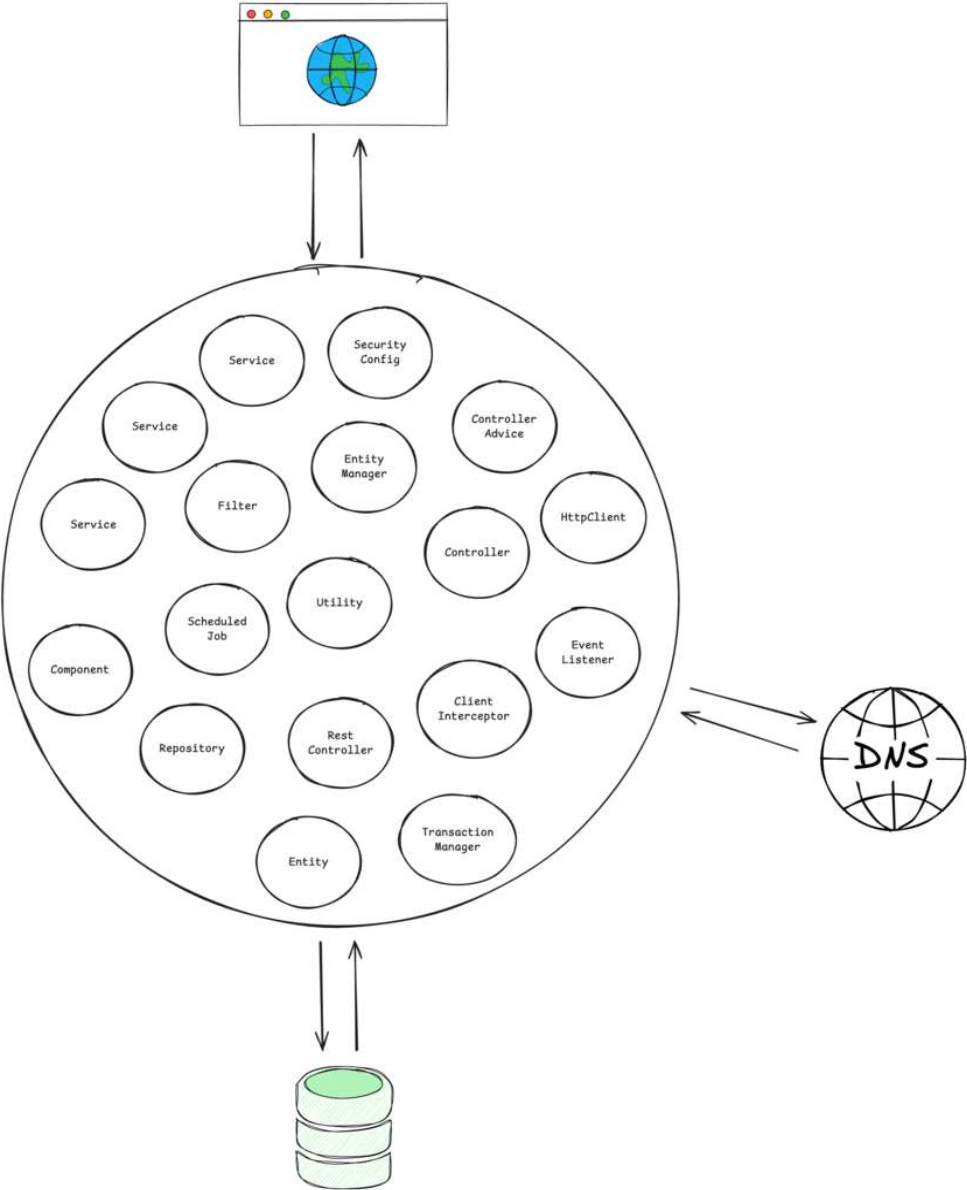
### The Slice Testing Hydra

Multiple Heads, Each Guarding a Layer

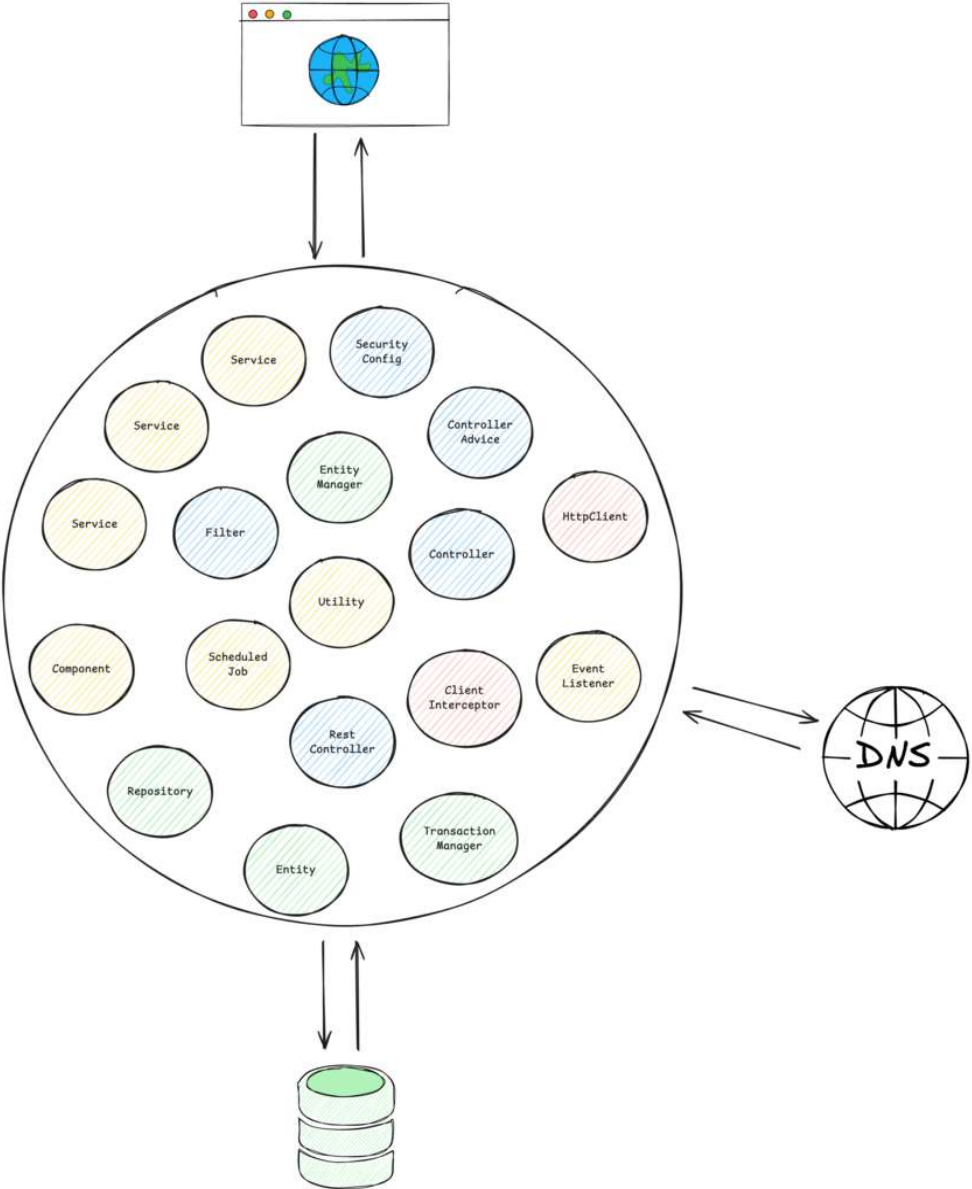


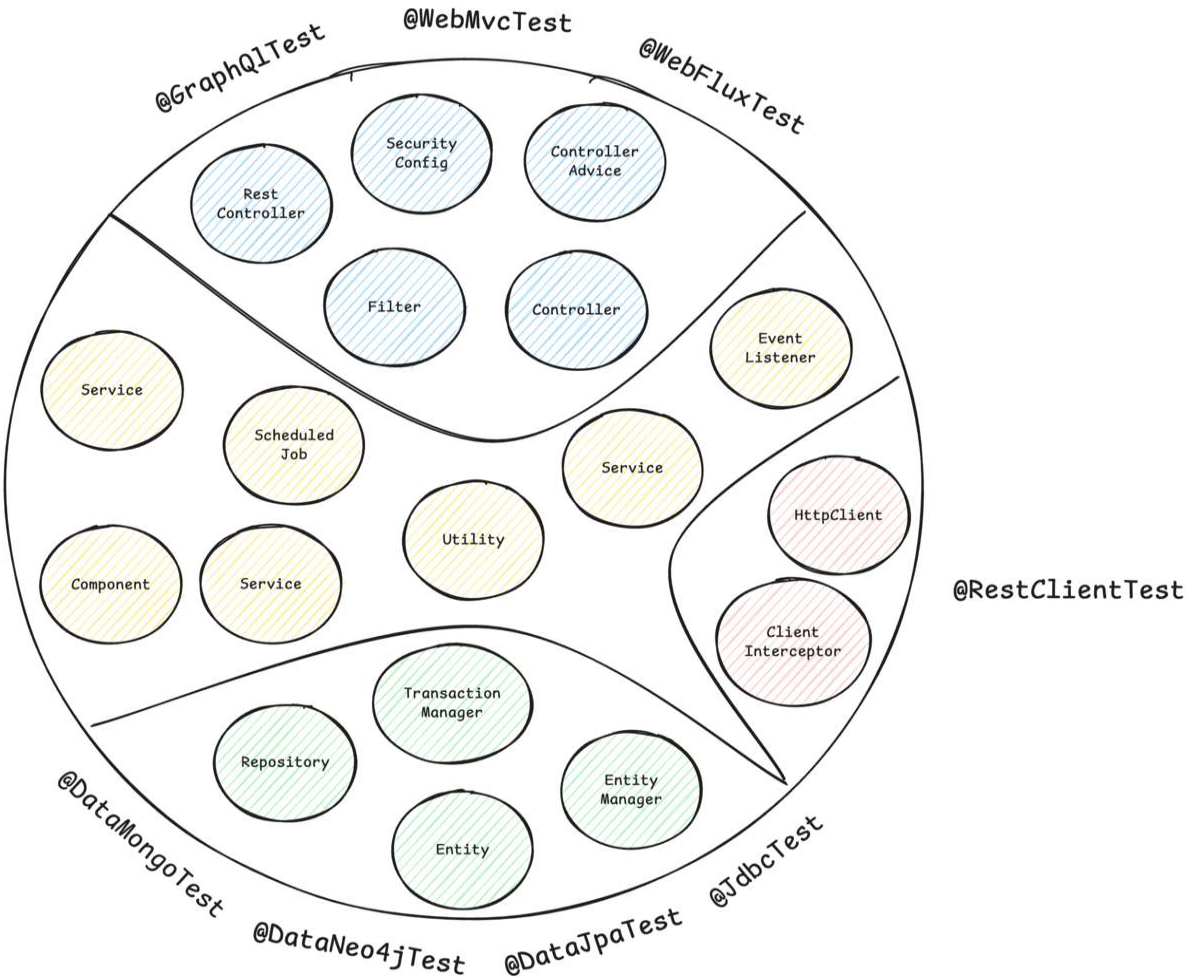


A Typical  
Spring ApplicationContext  
with different  
Spring Beans

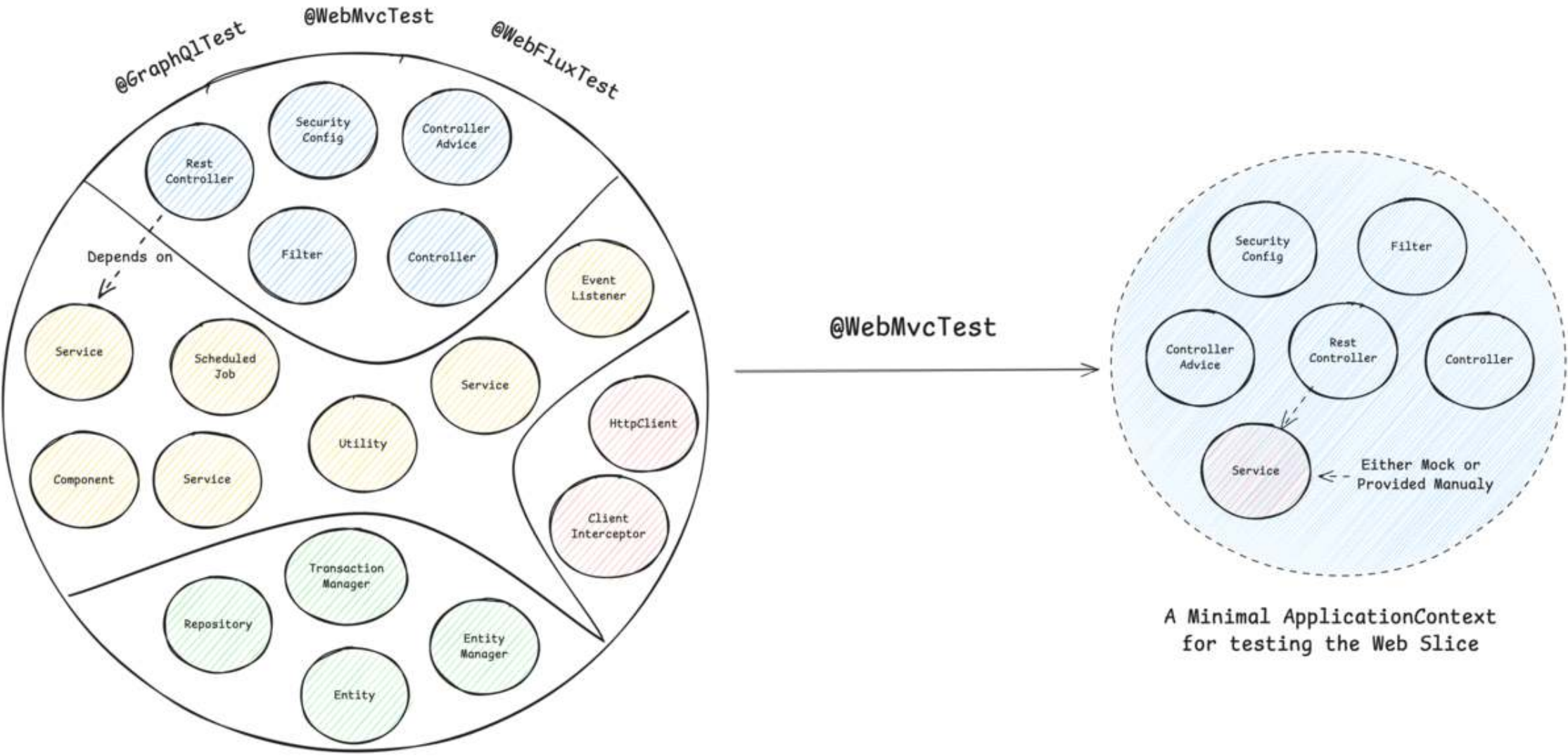


A Typical  
Spring ApplicationContext









## Spring Boot Test Slice Example: @WebMvcTest

```
1 @WebMvcTest(CustomerController.class)
2 @Import(SecurityConfig.class)
3 class CustomerControllerTest {
4
5     @Autowired
6     private MockMvc mockMvc;
7
8     @MockitoBean
9     private CustomerService customerService;
10
11     @Test
12     @WithMockUser
13     void shouldReturnLocationOfNewlyCreatedCustomer() throws Exception {
14         // ...
15     }
16 }
```



## Common Test Slices

- `@WebMvcTest` / `@WebFluxTest` - Controller layer
- `@DataJpaTest` / `@JdbcTest` - Persistence layer
- `@JsonTest` - JSON serialization/deserialization
- `@RestClientTest` - RestTemplate testing
- etc.





`@DataCouchbaseTest`  
`@DataLdapTest`  
`@RestClientTest`  
`@JsonTest`  
`@JooqTest`  
`@WebFluxTest`  
`@DataRedisTest`  
`@WebMvcTest`  
`@DataMongoTest`  
`@DataCassandraTest`  
`@GraphQLTest`  
`@DataNeo4jTest`  
`@WriteYourOwn*`  
`@DataJpaTest`  
`@SqsTest`  
`@JdbcTest`  
`@DataElasticsearchTest`



# Sliced Testing Spring Boot Applications 101

- **Core Concept:** Test a specific "slice" or layer of your application by loading a minimal, relevant part of the Spring `ApplicationContext`.
- **Confidence Gained:** Helps validate parts of your application where pure unit testing is insufficient, like the web, messaging, or data layer.
- **Prominent Examples:** Web layer ( `@WebMvcTest` ) and database layer ( `@DataJpaTest` )
- **Pitfalls:** Requires careful configuration to ensure only the necessary slice of the context is loaded.
- **Tools:** JUnit, Mockito, Spring Test, Spring Boot, Testcontainers



## Quest 3

### The Integration Testing Dragon

Guards the Full Treasure - but Demands Patience

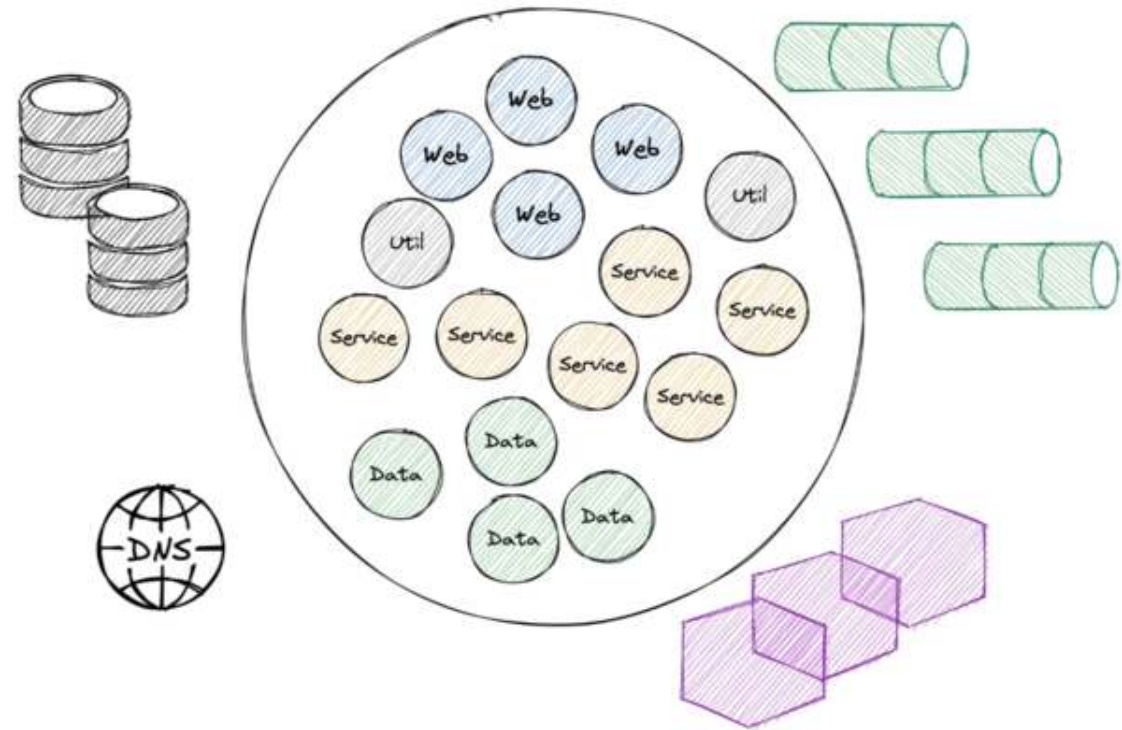




```
@SpringBootTest
class ApplicationTest {

    @Test
    void contextLoads() {
    }

}
```



## Starting the Entire **ApplicationContext**

- **Problem #1:** How to ensure surrounding infrastructure (e.g. database, queues, etc.) is present?
- **Problem #2:** How to handle HTTP communication from our application to remote services?
- **Problem #3:** How to keep our build time at a reasonable duration?



# Provide External Infrastructure with Testcontainers (Problem #1)

Running infrastructure components (databases, message brokers, etc.) in Docker containers for our tests becomes a breeze with [Testcontainers](#):

```
1 @Container
2 @ServiceConnection
3 static PostgreSQLContainer<?> postgres = new PostgreSQLContainer<>("postgres:16-alpine")
4     .withDatabaseName("testdb")
5     .withUsername("test")
6     .withPassword("test")
7     .withInitScript("init-postgres.sql");
```

This gives us an ephemeral PostgreSQL database for our tests:

```
1 $ docker ps
2 CONTAINER ID   IMAGE                                COMMAND                  CREATED          STATUS          PORTS                               NAMES
3 a958ee2887c6   postgres:16-alpine                 "docker-entrypoint.s..." 10 seconds ago   Up 9 seconds    0.0.0.0:32776->5432/tcp, [::]:32776->5432/tcp affectionate_cannon
4 ad0f804068dc   testcontainers/ryuk:0.12.0         "/bin/ryuk"              10 seconds ago   Up 9 seconds    0.0.0.0:32775->8080/tcp, [::]:32775->8080/tcp testcontainers-ryuk-1f9f76a6-46d4-4e19-85c1-e8364da12804
```

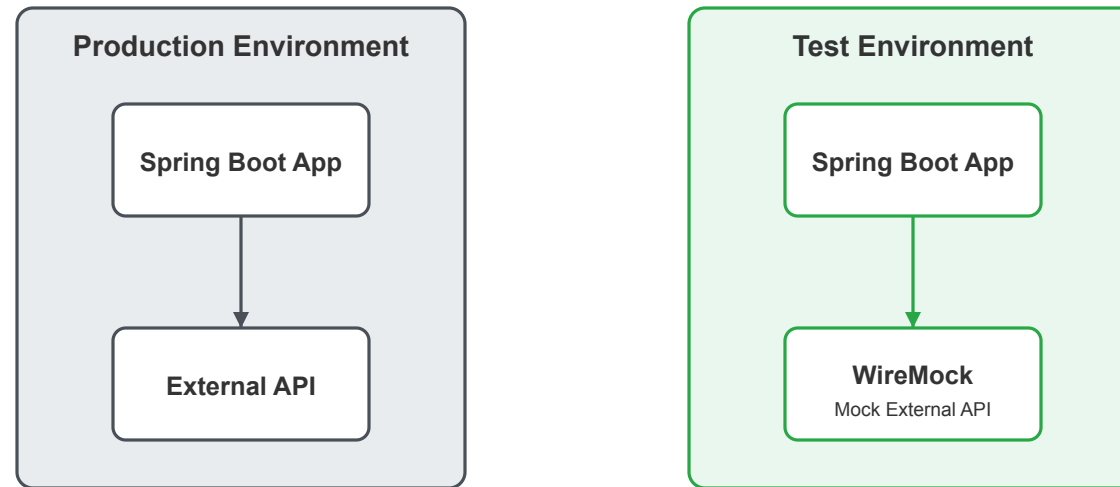




# Stub External HTTP Services with WireMock (Problem #2)

Consider [WireMock](#) to stub external HTTP services during tests.

## WireMock: HTTP Service Stubbing for Testing



### Key Benefits of WireMock

- Controlled test environment
- No network dependency
- Predictable responses
- Simulate error conditions
- Fast test execution
- Java integration



## Using WireMock for Integration Tests

- Run as in-memory service or Docker container to simulate connected HTTP services
- Override HTTP clients to connect to the WireMock server during tests

```
1 TestPropertyValues.of(  
2     "clients.open-library.base-url=http://localhost:" + wireMockServer.port())  
3     .applyTo(applicationContext);
```

```
1 wireMockServer.stubFor(  
2     get(urlPathEqualTo("/api/books/" + isbn))  
3         .willReturn(aResponse()  
4             .withHeader(HttpHeaders.CONTENT_TYPE, MediaType.APPLICATION_JSON_VALUE)  
5             .withBodyFile("book-response-success.json"))  
6 );
```



# Starting the Entire Spring Context - Version 1

- We access the application over HTTP like a user, the test and context run in separate threads (no `@Transactional` rollback), requires HTTP authentication

```
1 @SpringBootTest(webEnvironment = SpringBootTest.WebEnvironment.RANDOM_PORT)
2 class ApplicationServletContainerIT {
3
4     @LocalServerPort
5     private int port; // <-- we're running on a real port
6
7     @Test
8     void contextLoads(@Autowired WebTestClient webTestClient) {
9         webTestClient
10             .get()
11             .uri("/api/customers")
12             .header("Authorization", "Basic " + Base64.getEncoder().encodeToString("user:dummy".getBytes()))
13             .exchange()
14             .expectStatus()
15             .isOk();
16     }
17 }
```





## Starting the Entire Spring Context - Version 2

- The test and the context run in the same thread, hence we can rollback with `@Transactional` and simply override the security context with `@WithMockUser`

```
1 @SpringBootTest
2 // which is @SpringBootTest(webEnvironment = SpringBootTest.WebEnvironment.MOCK)
3 @AutoConfigureMockMvc
4 class ApplicationMockWebIT {
5
6     // @LocalServerPort
7     // private int port; <-- this would fail the test, there is no local port occupied
8
9     @Test
10    @WithMockUser
11    void givenCustomersThenReturnListForAuthenticatedUser(@Autowired MockMvc mockMvc) throws Exception {
12        mockMvc
13            .perform(get("/api/customers")
14                .header(ACCEPT, APPLICATION_JSON))
15            .andExpect(status().is(200))
16            .andExpect(content().contentType(APPLICATION_JSON))
17            .andExpect(jsonPath("$.size()", is(1)));
18    }
19 }
```



# Integration Testing Spring Boot Applications 101

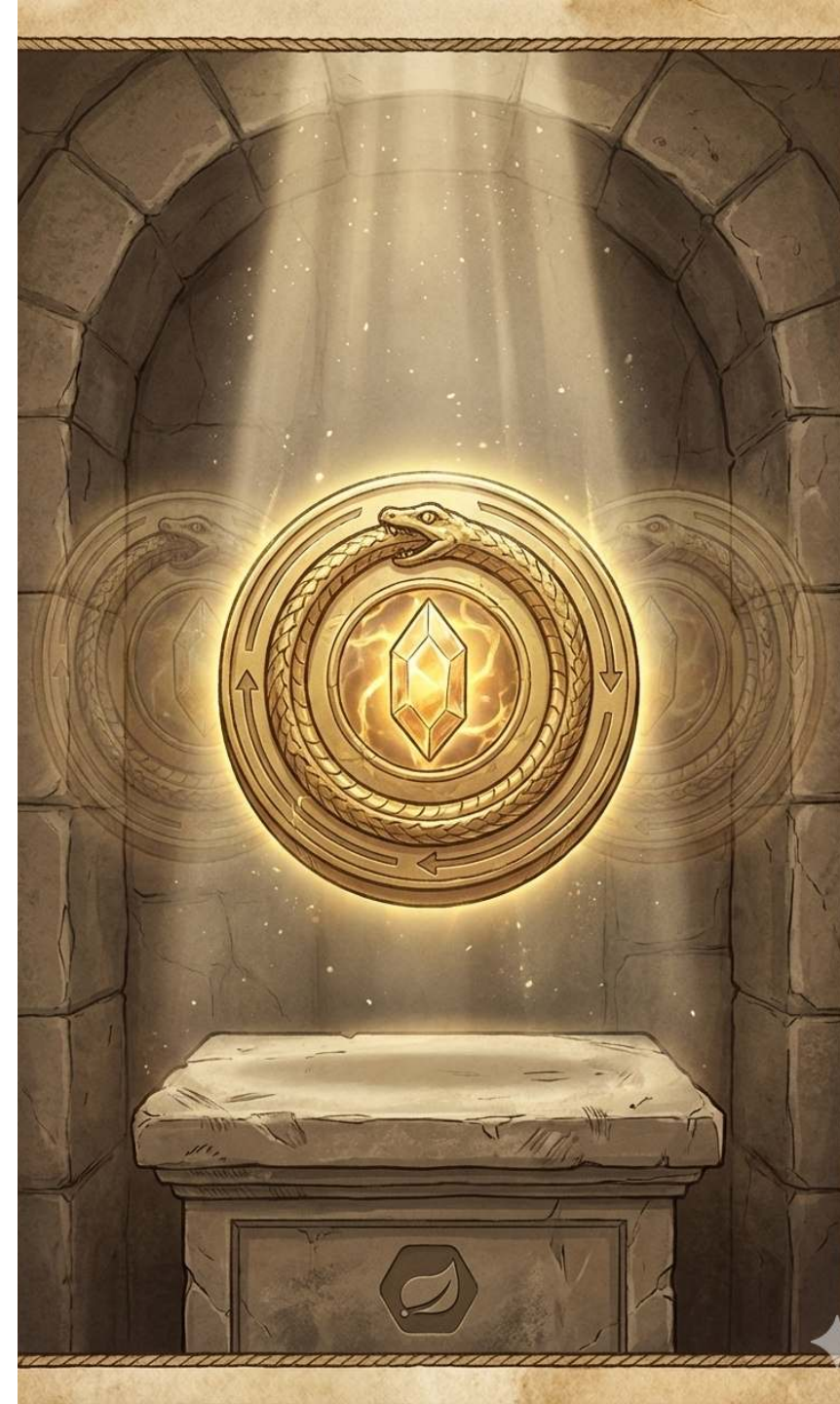
- **Core Concept:** Start the entire Spring application context, often on a random local port, and test the application through its external interfaces (e.g., REST API).
- **Confidence Gained:** Validates the integration of all internal components working together as a complete application.
- **Best Practices:** Use `@SpringBootTest` to run the app on a local port.
- **Pitfalls:** Slower to run than unit or sliced tests. Managing the lifecycle of dependent services can be complex.
- **Tools:** JUnit, Mockito, Spring Test, Spring Boot, Testcontainers, WireMock (for mocking external HTTP services), Selenium (for browser-based UI testing)



# Quest Item 1

## The Caching Amulet

Helps You Reuse What You Already Built



# Integration Testing - The Need for Speed

- **The Problem:** Integration tests require a started & initialized Spring `ApplicationContext`, which slows down the build
- **The Solution:** Spring Test `TestContext` Caching – stores an already started Spring `ApplicationContext` for reuse
- This feature is part of Spring Test (included in every Spring Boot project via `spring-boot-starter-test`)

Example of speed improvement:





Test run time: 3506ms

OrderIT  
requiring context  
configuration with the  
hash code #327321289

Context cache lookup

PaymentIT  
requiring context  
configuration with the  
hash code #327321289

CheckoutIT  
requiring context  
configuration with the  
hash code #565212314

### Spring TestContext Context Cache

Cache Key

Cache Value

no cached context,  
tests needs  
to start the context



Test run time: 3506ms

OrderIT  
requiring context  
configuration with the  
hash code #327321289

Test run time: 406ms

PaymentIT  
requiring context  
configuration with the  
hash code #327321289

CheckoutIT  
requiring context  
configuration with the  
hash code #565212314

test gets cached context and  
finishes the test very fast

Spring TestContext Context Cache

Cache Key

Cache Value

#327321289



Test run time: 3506ms

OrderIT  
requiring context  
configuration with the  
hash code #327321289

Test run time: 406ms

PaymentIT  
requiring context  
configuration with the  
hash code #327321289

Test run time: 4506ms

CheckoutIT  
requiring context  
configuration with the  
hash code #565212314

### Spring TestContext Context Cache

Cache Key

Cache Value

#327321289



#565212314



## How the Cache Key is Built

```
1 // DefaultContextCache.java
2 private final Map<MergedContextConfiguration, ApplicationContext> contextMap =
3     Collections.synchronizedMap(new LruCache(32, 0.75f));
```

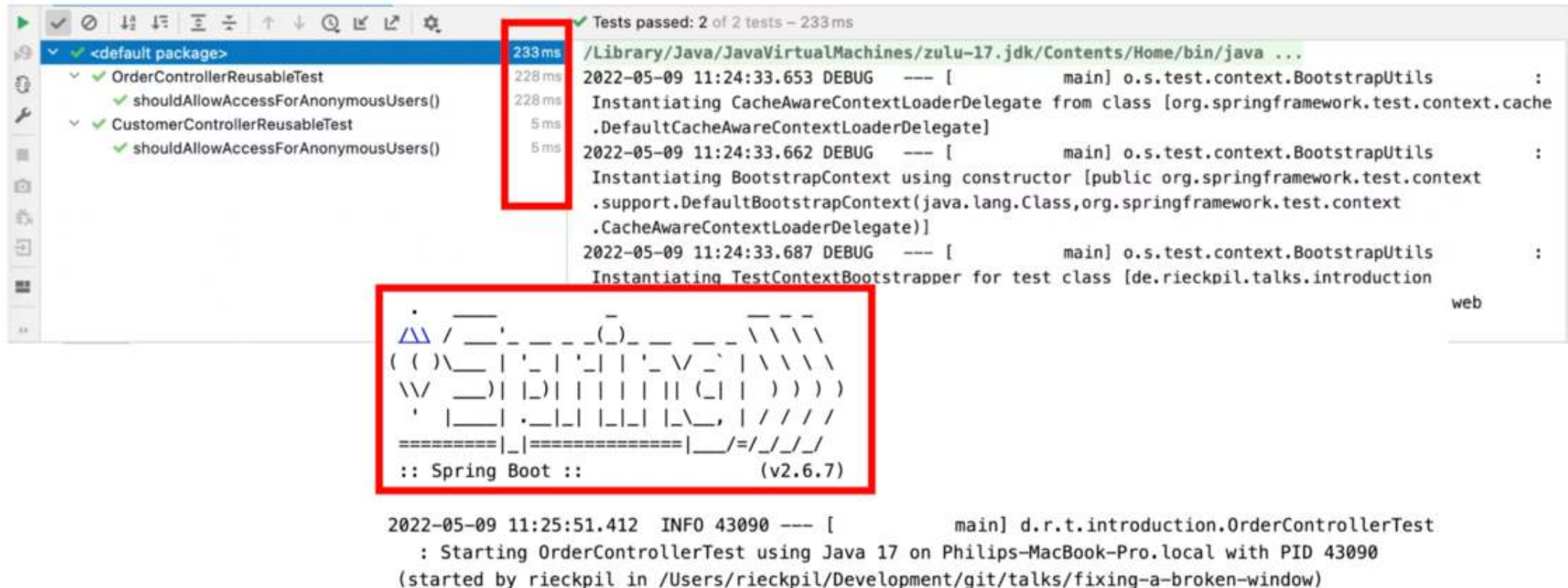
The following information is part of the Cache Key ( `MergedContextConfiguration` ):

- `activeProfiles ( @ActiveProfiles )`
- `contextInitializersClasses ( @ContextConfiguration )`
- `propertySourceLocations ( @TestPropertySource )`
- `propertySourceProperties ( @TestPropertySource )`
- `contextCustomizer ( @MockitoBean , @MockBean , @DynamicPropertySource , ...)`
- etc.





## Detect Context Restarts - Visually



```
✓ Tests passed: 2 of 2 tests - 233 ms
✓ <default package>
  ✓ OrderControllerReusableTest
    ✓ shouldAllowAccessForAnonymousUsers()
  ✓ CustomerControllerReusableTest
    ✓ shouldAllowAccessForAnonymousUsers()

/Library/Java/JavaVirtualMachines/zulu-17.jdk/Contents/Home/bin/java ...
2022-05-09 11:24:33.653 DEBUG --- [main] o.s.test.context.BootstrapUtils :
Instantiating CacheAwareContextLoaderDelegate from class [org.springframework.test.context.cache
.DefaultCacheAwareContextLoaderDelegate]
2022-05-09 11:24:33.662 DEBUG --- [main] o.s.test.context.BootstrapUtils :
Instantiating BootstrapContext using constructor [public org.springframework.test.context
.support.DefaultBootstrapContext(java.lang.Class,org.springframework.test.context
.CacheAwareContextLoaderDelegate)]
2022-05-09 11:24:33.687 DEBUG --- [main] o.s.test.context.BootstrapUtils :
Instantiating TestContextBootstrapper for test class [de.riekpil.talks.introduction
web

:: Spring Boot :: (v2.6.7)

2022-05-09 11:25:51.412 INFO 43090 --- [main] d.r.t.introduction.OrderControllerTest
: Starting OrderControllerTest using Java 17 on Philips-MacBook-Pro.local with PID 43090
(started by rieckpil in /Users/riekpil/Development/git/talks/fixing-a-broken-window)
```



## Detect Context Restarts - with Logs

```
<logger name="org.springframework.test.context" level="TRACE" />
```

```
2022-05-05 14:27:38.136 DEBUG 42500 --- [          main] org.springframework.test.context.cache : Spring test
ApplicationContext cache statistics: [DefaultContextCache@68e62b3b size = 1, maxSize = 32, parentContextCount = 0,
hitCount = 11, missCount = 1]
2022-05-05 14:27:38.136 DEBUG 42500 --- [          main] tractDirtiesContextTestExecutionListener : After test class:
context [DefaultTestContext@325bb9a6 testClass = ApplicationIT, testInstance = [null], testMethod = [null], testException
= [null], mergedContextConfiguration = [WebMergedContextConfiguration@1d12b024 testClass = ApplicationIT, locations =
'{}', classes = '{class de.rieckpil.talks.Application}', contextInitializerClasses = '[]', activeProfiles = '{}',
propertySourceLocations = '{}', propertySourceProperties = '{org.springframework.boot.test.context
.SpringBootTestContextBootstrapper=true, server.port=0}', contextCustomizers = set[org.springframework.boot.test.context
.filter.ExcludeFilterContextCustomizer@5215cd9a, org.springframework.boot.test.json
.DuplicateJsonObjectContextCustomizerFactory$DuplicateJsonObjectContextCustomizer@9257031, org.springframework.boot.test
```



## Detect Context Restarts - with Tooling



An [open-source Spring Test utility](#) that provides visualization and insights for Spring Test execution, with a focus on Spring context caching statistics.

**Overall goal:** Identify optimization opportunities in your Spring Test suite to speed up your builds and ship to production faster and with more confidence.



## The Final Boss

Developers tend to consult AI/StackOverflow for integration test issues and often copy advice from the internet without knowing the implications:

```
1 @SpringBootTest
2 @DirtiesContext
3 // this instructs Spring to remove the context from the cache
4 // and rebuild a new context on every request
5 public abstract class AbstractIntegrationTest {
6
7 }
```

The setup above will **disable** the context caching feature and slow down the builds significantly!





## New in Spring Framework 7: Pausing Contexts

See Release Notes von [Spring Framework 7.0.0 M7](#).

### Pausing of Test Application Contexts

The Spring TestContext framework is caching application context instances within test suites for faster runs. As of Spring Framework 7.0, we now pause test application contexts when they're not used.

This means an application context stored in the context cache will be stopped when it is no longer actively in use and automatically restarted the next time the context is retrieved from the cache.

Specifically, the latter will restart all auto-startup beans in the application context, effectively restoring the lifecycle state.



## Quest Item 2

### The Lightning Shield

Many Cores, One Goal



# Test Parallelization

**Goal:** Reduce build time and get faster feedback

Requirements:

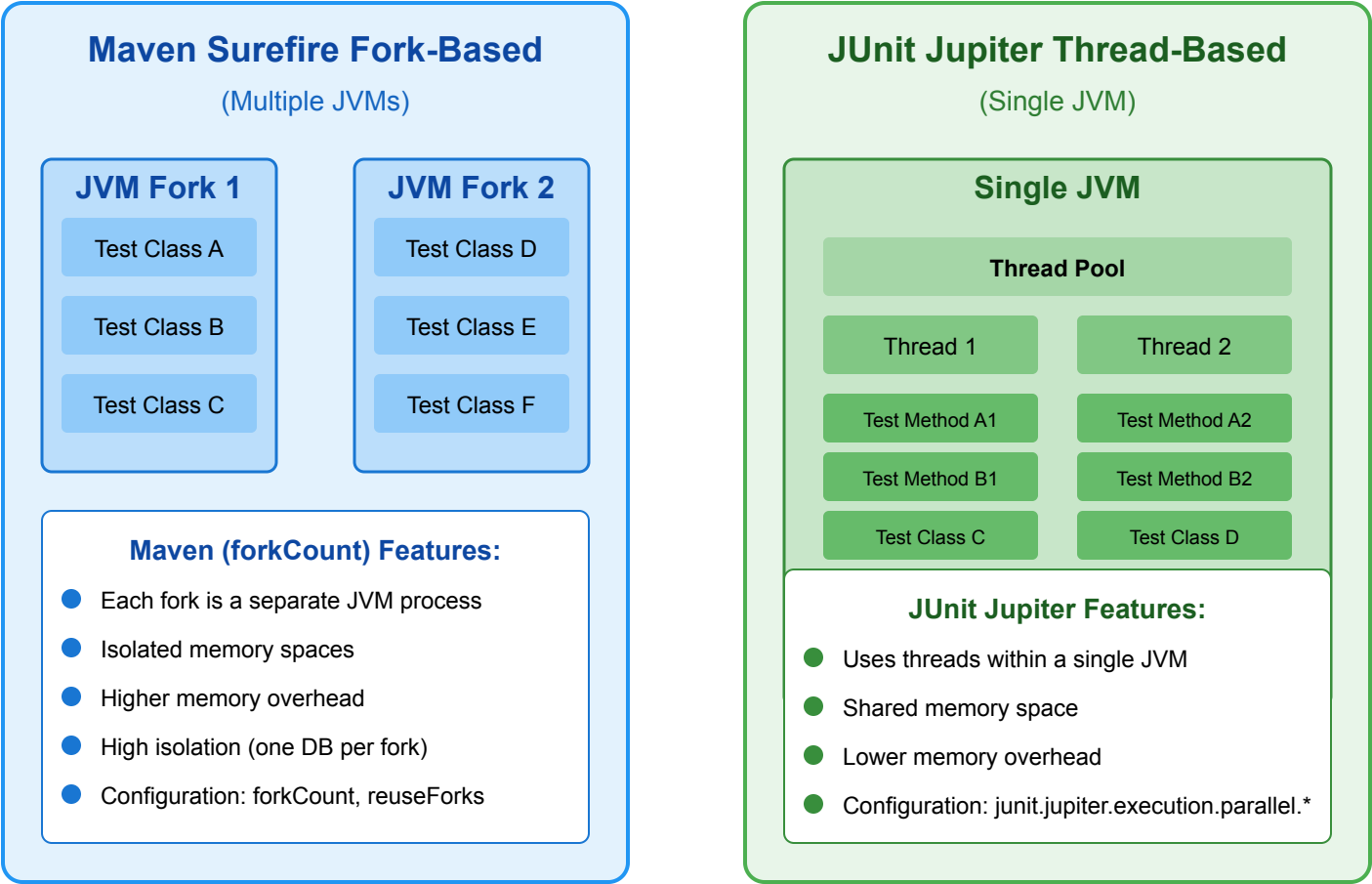
- No shared state
- No dependency between tests and their execution order
- No mutation of global state

Two ways to achieve this:

- Fork a new JVM with Surefire/Failsafe (or for the Gradle test task) and let it run in parallel
- Use JUnit Jupiter's parallelization mode and let it run in the same JVM with multiple threads



# Java Test Parallelization Options





# Reuse Containers with Testcontainers

- Bootstrapping new containers can take a significant amount of time
- Enable container reuse in Testcontainers when possible: `.withReuse(true)`
- Singleton containers per test run are preferable to `@Testcontainers` (container per test class)
- Speed up container startup with e.g. predefined database snapshots

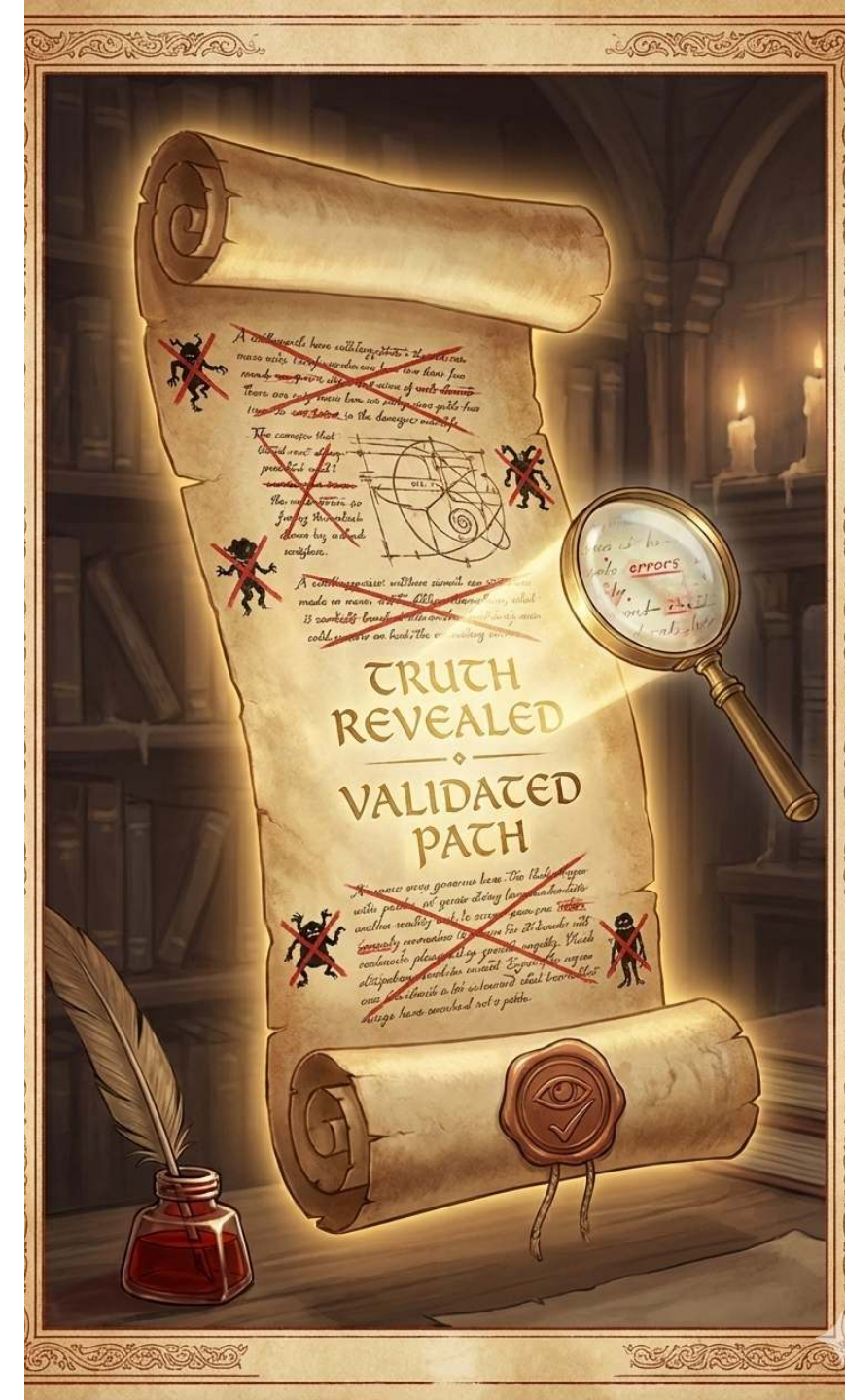
```
1 private static PostgreSQLContainer<?> postgresModule = new PostgreSQLContainer<>("myteampostgres:42")
2   .withDatabaseName("testdb")
3   .withUsername("testuser")
4   .withPassword("testpass");
5
6 static {
7     postgresModule.start();
8 }
```



## Quest Item 3

### The Scroll of Truth

Coverage Lies, Mutants Don't



## Introducing: Mutation Testing

- Having high code coverage might give you a **false sense of security**
- Mutation Testing with **PIT**
- Beyond Line Coverage: Traditional tools like JaCoCo show which code runs during tests, but PIT verifies if our tests actually detect when code behaves incorrectly by introducing "**mutations**" to our source code.
- Quality Guarantee: PIT automatically **modifies our code** (changing conditionals, return values, etc.) to ensure our tests fail when they should, **revealing blind spots** in seemingly comprehensive test suites.



```
public Long registerUser(String username, int age) { no usages

    if(this.userRepository.findByUsername(username).isPresent()) {
        throw new IllegalArgumentException("Username already exists");
    }

    if(age <= 18) {
        throw new IllegalArgumentException("User is underaged");
    }

    if(username.equals("ADMIN")) {
        // default admin user id
        return 3L;
    }

    return userRepository.save(username);
}
```



Existing Code & Tests

Mutant from UserService  
(e.g. <= gets !=)



run relevant  
tests



Test fails X

Mutant was successfully detected :)

Mutant from UserService  
(e.g. equals gets !=equals)



run relevant  
tests



Test is green

Mutant wasn't detected :(

Mutant from UserService  
(e.g. return 3 gets return 42)



run relevant  
tests



Test is green

Mutant wasn't detected :(





## Act 5: The Triumphant Exit

- Spring Boot applications come with batteries-included and excellent testing support
- We've completed three main quests: Unit testing, Sliced testing, and Integration testing
- Three core quest items help us to speed up and validate our tests:
  - Context Caching
  - Test Parallelization
  - Mutation Testing



## What's Next?

Testing is a team sport, make sure your whole team levels up together

- Spring Boot [testing workshops](#) (in-house/remote/hybrid)
- Further Spring Boot testing resources (courses, eBooks, articles) at [rieckpil.de](https://rieckpil.de)
- [Consulting offerings](#), e.g. the Test Maturity Assessment for projects/teams





## Bring This Talk to Your Company!

I offer this and similar Spring Boot testing talks **for free** for companies as:

- **Lunch & Learn** sessions
- **Internal conferences** and developer days
- **Team training** events

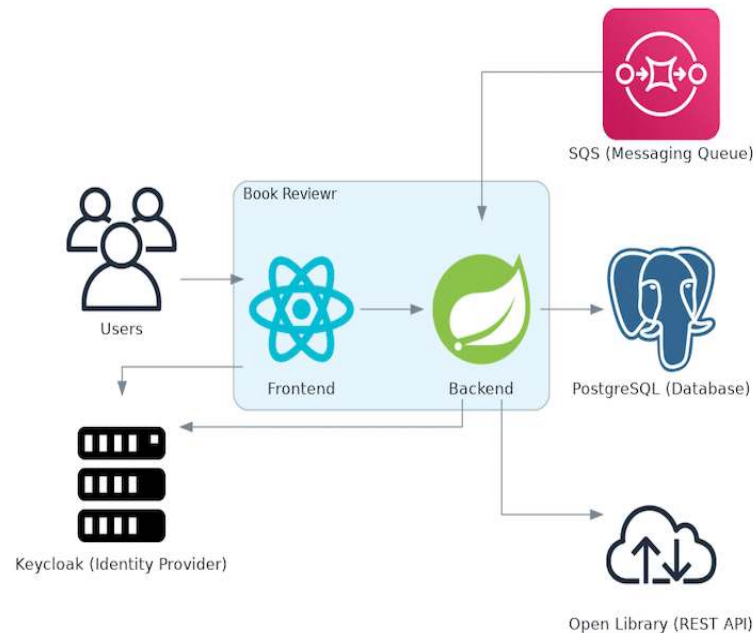
Reach out via LinkedIn or email ([philip@pragmatech.digital](mailto:philip@pragmatech.digital)) to discuss the details and schedule a session for your team.



# My Entire Spring Boot Testing Knowledge Combined

... in one on-demand online course.

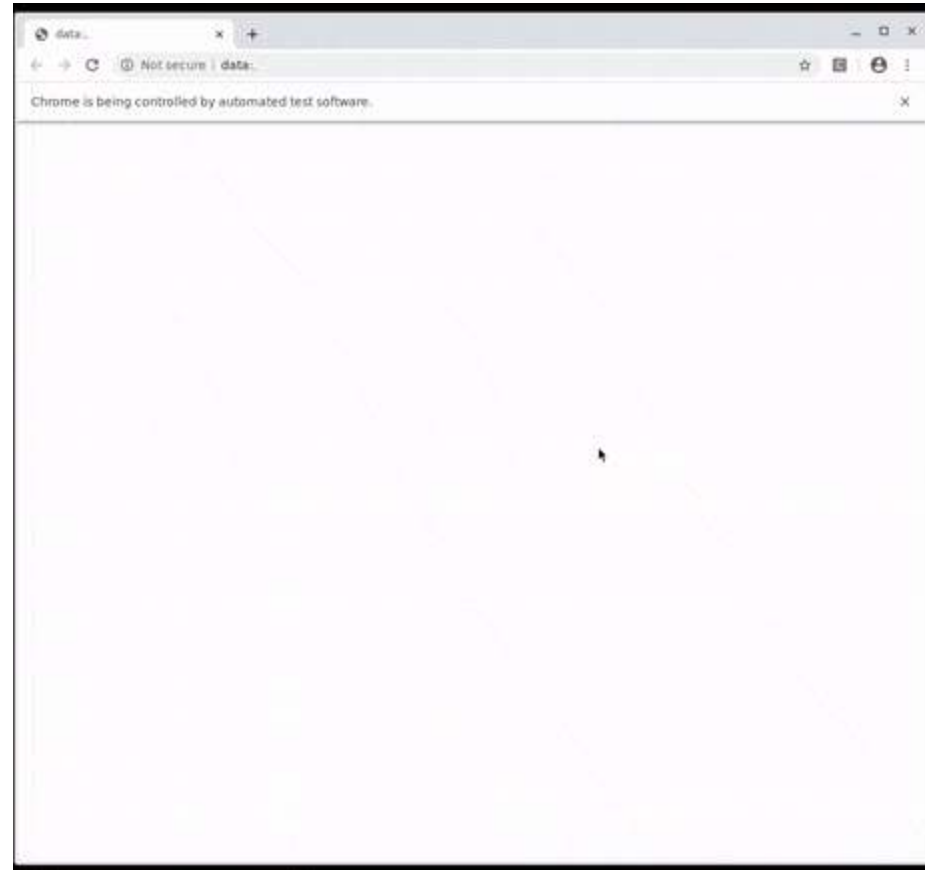
Learn how to test and verify a real-world self-contained system with the [Testing Spring Boot Applications Masterclass](#)





# Covering Unit, Sliced, Integration and E2E Tests

... with 130 course lessons and 12h+ of content



**Nenad Ikovic**  
1 year ago

Hello Philip, you did an excellent job with this masterclass. I would appreciate if more fellows would book your class, this would for sure improve writing tests in a lot of projects.

**Vinayak Kariger**  
2 years ago

Hello Philip,

I thoroughly enjoyed this course and it definitely added to my skills. Looking forward to putting this learning into practice. Thank you for your efforts in making this course.

Thanks and Regards  
Vinayak Kariger

**Zayed Alabbad**  
@zalabbad\_ - Follow

Just completed the "Testing Spring Boot Applications Masterclass" course by [@rickphil](#). It's one of the best courses I've had and I highly recommend it.

Practical real-life examples with a very clear explanation. Thanks Philip!

**Philip Reicks**  
Created this post

**CERTIFICATE of Completion**

PROUDLY PRESENTED TO

**Zayed Alabbad**

This Certificate is Awarded To Zayed Alabbad For Successfully Completing The "Testing Spring Boot Applications Masterclass".

Course Topics: In-Depth Coverage Of Unit, Integration, And End-To-End Testing Techniques And Patterns For Spring Boot Applications Using Testing Tools Like JUnit 5, Mockito, Testcontainers, WireMock, And Selenium.

9:39 AM · Dec 24, 2023

6 6 Reply Copy link

[Read 1 reply](#)

**Michael Kupitski**  
2 years ago

Philip, thank you very much for this course. It's really great and full of valuable knowledge, examples, tips and good practices. It was a pleasure to learn from your experience.

Your course is very comprehensive and there's a need to spend a lot of time to complete it but it's worth every minute. To be exact I believe that after those many hours I saved weeks or months of self-learning.

It's also very nice to be first here with a comment 🙌

You did a really good job. I hope this is not the last course in your portfolio and if there are other topics/technologies which are so well-known to you be notice that you have at least one happy customer now who would love to buy another one. Maybe something about event-driven architecture/apps?

Thank's a lot! 🙌

**juaanhueva01**  
10 months ago

Hi Philip,

Thank you very much for the course, it is just what I needed and I found it very interesting, you have solved many of the doubts I had. I will definitely recommend this course.

**Mert D.** · 2  
Software Developer at VDAB | Oracle Certified Professional  
10 Std. · Beantwortet · 📌

✳️ Excited to share that I've completed the Spring Boot Testing Masterclass by [Philip Reicks](#)! 🙌🏻 This comprehensive course delved deep into testing Spring Boot applications, providing valuable insights into crafting effective unit, integration, and end-to-end tests using top-notch testing libraries like JUnit 5, Mockito, AssertJ, JSONAssert, Selenium, Selenide, WireMock, Testcontainers, LocalStack, Availability, and Spring Boot Test. The hands-on approach and real-world application scenarios, such as the modern full-stack application built with Java 21, Spring Boot 3, React 18, TypeScript 4, AWS, PostgreSQL, and Keycloak, have significantly boosted my confidence and productivity in ensuring the robustness of Spring Boot applications. 🙌🏻

🙌🏻 A heartfelt thanks to [Philip Reicks](#) for the outstanding guidance and expertise shared in the course. Also, immense gratitude for my employers at VDAB and Vlaanderen connect, for providing the opportunity to enhance my skills. 🙌🏻 Excited to implement these learnings and contribute to building better Spring Boot applications! 🙌🏻

✳️ [#SpringBoot](#) ✳️ [#TestingMasterclass](#) ✳️ [#ContinuousLearning](#)

**Philip Reicks**  
Created this post

**CERTIFICATE of Completion**

PROUDLY PRESENTED TO

**Mert Demirok**

This Certificate is Awarded To Mert Demirok For Successfully Completing The "Testing Spring Boot Applications Masterclass".

Course Topics: In-Depth Coverage Of Unit, Integration, And End-To-End Testing Techniques And Patterns For Spring Boot Applications Using Testing Tools Like JUnit 5, Mockito, Testcontainers, WireMock, And Selenium.

3 Sie und 19 weitere Personen

2 Kommentare · 1 direkt geteilter Beitrag

**P7eter T7ave**  
2 years ago

I have really enjoyed the class. It has provided a major gap in my skillset. The challenge now is to apply this knowledge in practice!

Vote Share

[Reply to P7eter T7ave](#)

**Lars**  
2 years ago

Philip, thank you for this course. I learned a lot of new tricks in regards to testing with spring and will highly recommend your course when anyone is looking for such material.

**rijuvrijan**  
2 months ago

Hi Philip,

I really enjoyed this course. Gave me such immense knowledge and understanding not around testing Spring boot apps but also around testing in general.

Appreciate your spending time in putting this together.

**Xavier Escudero Sabadell** · 1  
Principal Software Test Architect  
5 Tage · 📌

I've just completed the Testing Spring Boot Applications Masterclass!

The depth and completeness of the content truly stands out. Exceptional content with comprehensive coverage and rich examples about JUnit5, Mockito, Spring Boot Testing, Test Containers and Wiremock, among others.

Great course, [Philip Reicks](#)!!!!

**Philip Reicks**  
Created this post

**CERTIFICATE of Completion**

PROUDLY PRESENTED TO

**Xavier Escudero Sabadell**

This Certificate is Awarded To Xavier Escudero Sabadell For Successfully Completing The "Testing Spring Boot Applications Masterclass".

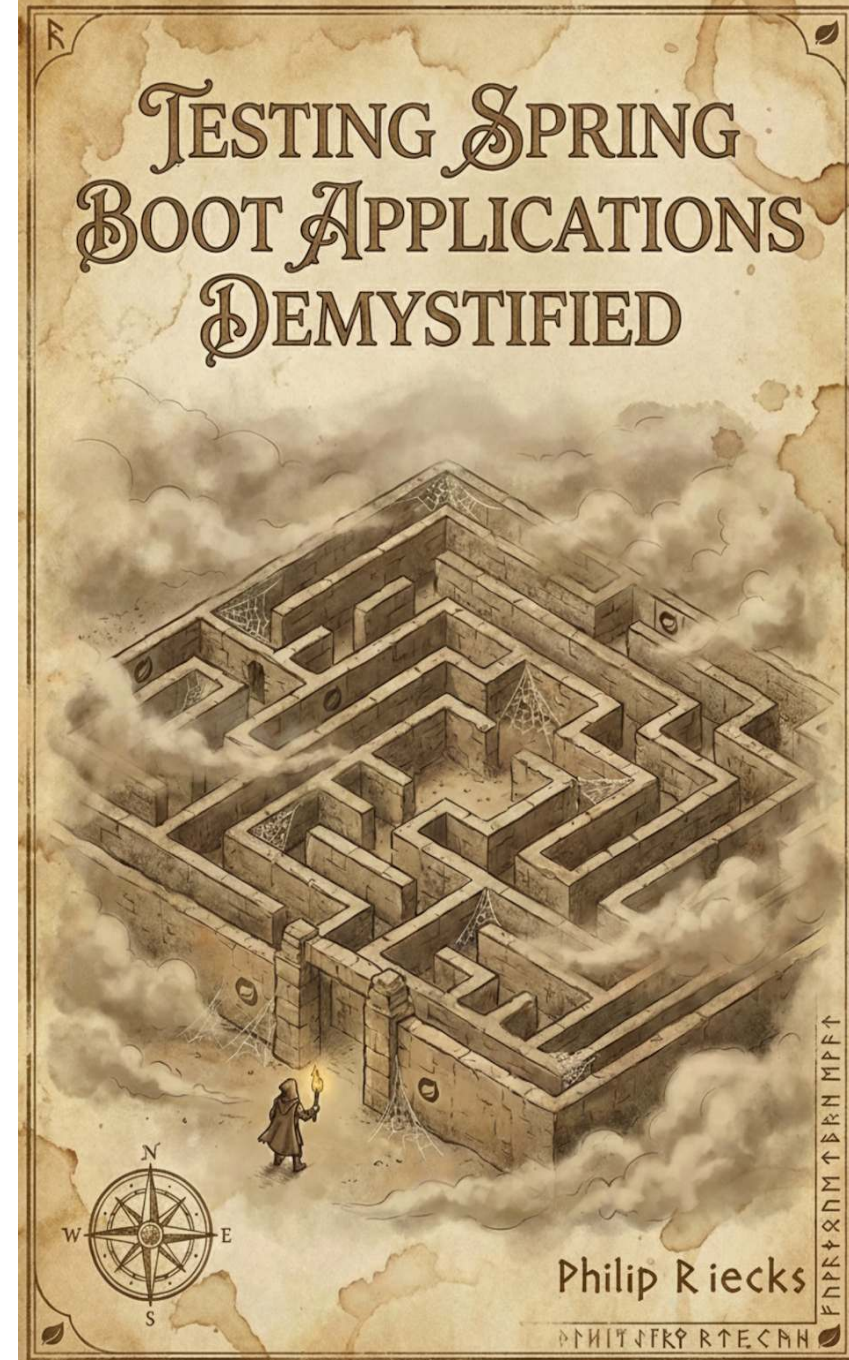
Course Topics: In-Depth Coverage Of Unit, Integration, And End-To-End Testing Techniques And Patterns For Spring Boot Applications Using Testing Tools Like JUnit 5, Mockito, Testcontainers, WireMock, And Selenium.

5 Sie und 36 weitere Personen

5 Kommentare · 1 direkt geteilter Beitrag

## Don't Leave Empty-Handed

- Get the complementary **Testing Spring Boot Applications Demystified** for free (instead of \$9)
- 120+ Pages with practical hands-on advice to ship code with confidence
- Get the eBook by joining our [newsletter](#)





# Joyful Testing!

Get your Spring Boot testing eBook:



Reach out any time via:

- [LinkedIn](#) (Philip Riecks)
- [X](#) (@rieckpil)
- [Mail](mailto:philip@pragmatech.digital) (philip@pragmatech.digital)

